

Olympiad Test Paper — Social Science (Class 7) — Paper 5

Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Social Science (NCERT Class 7)
Chapter	14 — India and Her Neighbours
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct.

Apex traps: a maritime neighbour is no 'lesser' neighbour (the sea joins coasts as a land boundary joins lands); an open border (India-Nepal) is a real, recognised boundary that needs cooperation, not merger; landlocked Nepal and Bhutan still depend on the sea via Indian ports; Indian culture reached Thailand, Cambodia, Indonesia PEACEFULLY by trade, travel and religion (Ramakien is Thailand's own retelling), never conquest; direction/side and link-type mix-ups (Pakistan/Afghanistan west-northwest, Bangladesh/Myanmar east, Sri Lanka/Maldives south; China land not maritime; Iran/Oman western sea-trade neighbours); figures land boundary ~15,100 km and coastline ~11,100 km; SAARC (1985) is cooperation not conquest or merger. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. A class sorts India's neighbours into 'land' and 'maritime' columns. One student writes a rule: 'A country goes under maritime only if it has NO land at all and is pure ocean.' Applying this flawed rule, where would Sri Lanka wrongly end up, and what is the correct placement?

(A) It would correctly fall under maritime, because the rule about 'no land at all' matches an island perfectly

(B) It would go under land neighbours, because any country with land must be a land neighbour

(C) It would be deleted as a non-neighbour, because only countries touching India by land are neighbours

(D) It would wrongly be left out of both columns since Sri Lanka has land; correctly it is a maritime neighbour because it shares no land border with India and is reached across the sea

2. India's land boundary is roughly 15,100 km and its coastline roughly 11,100 km. A student concludes from these two figures that 'India must have more land neighbours than maritime neighbours.' Why is this inference unsound?

(A) Boundary length does not fix the number of neighbours; the figures describe how long the borders and coast are, not how many countries lie along each

(B) It is sound, because a longer land boundary always means a greater number of land neighbours

(C) It is unsound because the coastline is actually longer than the land boundary

(D) It is unsound because India in fact has no maritime neighbours at all

3. Two neighbours both lack their own usable sea access of the normal kind, yet for opposite reasons: one is ringed by land, the other is a string of low islands surrounded by sea. Identify the pair and the contrast.

(A) Bhutan is a maritime archipelago while Nepal is a single large island, so both face the open sea

(B) Sri Lanka is landlocked while the Maldives sits in the Himalayas, so both lack a coastline

(C) Pakistan is landlocked while Afghanistan is an island chain, so neither can trade by sea

(D) Nepal is landlocked with no coast and reaches the ocean through Indian ports, while the Maldives is an archipelago that is all coast and sea yet so small and scattered it leans on regional partners for security

4. A traveller leaves the Ganga plains, crosses the north-west mountains by an ancient overland route into Central Asia, and notes Buddhist remains along the way. Which neighbour and which route best fit this journey, and why does it disprove 'Afghanistan was always cut off from India'?

(A) Sri Lanka via the Dakshinapatha; the southern sea route proves Afghanistan was isolated

(B) Afghanistan via the Uttarapatha; the route shows Afghanistan was a living link on India's overland trade and cultural network long ago

(C) Myanmar via the spice route; the eastern sea passage shows Afghanistan faced only the ocean

(D) Bhutan via the Silk Route; the Himalayan kingdom blocked all contact with Central Asia

5. The Ganga and Brahmaputra rise in or near the Himalayas, flow through India, and reach the sea only after entering Bangladesh. A planner upstream in India wants to divert most of the water. Using the chapter's idea of transboundary rivers, what is the soundest principle?

- (A) India may take all the water upstream, since a river belongs entirely to the country it flows through first
- (B) Bangladesh should build a wall at the border to stop the rivers crossing into its territory
- (C) Because the rivers cross the border and Bangladesh lies downstream, the two countries are tied together and must manage the shared waters by agreement
- (D) The rivers stop at the border, so India's use cannot affect Bangladesh at all

6. Bhutan, the 'Land of the Thunder Dragon', earns much by selling electricity yet measures success by Gross National Happiness. A student says these two facts contradict each other. Resolve the tension.

- (A) They contradict, because GNH forbids any earning of money whatsoever
- (B) They contradict, because selling electricity proves Bhutan cares only about wealth
- (C) There is no contradiction, because GNH measures only the size of the army and ignores the economy
- (D) There is no contradiction: GNH counts wellbeing, environment, governance and culture alongside income, and clean hydroelectricity from mountain rivers can earn money while caring for the environment

7. A debate: Aria claims 'the open India-Nepal border proves borders are pointless, so cooperation between the two is unnecessary.' Vir disagrees. Which reasoning is correct?

- (A) Aria is correct: an open border means no boundary exists, so there is nothing to cooperate about
- (B) Aria is correct: free crossing legally merges Nepal into India, ending the need for two governments
- (C) Vir is correct, but only because Nepal and India share a maritime border rather than a land one
- (D) Vir is correct: an open border is still a recognised boundary between two sovereign states, and precisely because people and goods cross it freely, the two must cooperate to keep it safe and orderly

8. Thai kings bear the name 'Rama', an old capital was 'Ayutthaya', and Thailand has its own epic, the Ramakien. A student concludes India must have ruled Thailand. What single best statement both names the flaw and gives the correct picture?

- (A) The student is right, because such close name-echoes can only result from direct Indian rule
- (B) The flaw is that these names are mere coincidence with no link to India at all

(C) The flaw is assuming influence requires conquest; in fact Indian culture and the Ramayana reached Thailand peacefully through trade, travel and religion, and the Ramakien is Thailand's own retelling shaped by Thai culture

(D) The flaw is that Thailand actually conquered India and carried the names home

9. Angkor Wat in Cambodia carries Hindu themes, Borobudur stands in Indonesia, and 'Suvarnabhumi' was an old Indian name for the region. Taken together, what is the strongest single conclusion?

(A) India built and owned these monuments as colonies it ruled by force

(B) South-East Asia had no contact with India until modern times

(C) Indian religion, art and names spread across the seas to South-East Asia through trade and travel and were adapted locally, showing deep peaceful cultural exchange

(D) These are unrelated coincidences with no shared Indian origin

10. Which sequence correctly orders, from India's south to its north-west, the neighbours: Maldives, Sri Lanka, China, Pakistan?

(A) Pakistan and China to the south, Sri Lanka to the west, Maldives to the north

(B) Sri Lanka to the north, Maldives to the east, China to the south, Pakistan to the north-west

(C) Maldives and Sri Lanka to the south, China to the north, Pakistan to the west and north-west

(D) China and Pakistan to the south, Maldives and Sri Lanka to the north across the Himalayas

11. A textbook column titled 'maritime neighbours' lists Sri Lanka, the Maldives, Nepal and China. Two entries are wrong. Which two, and why?

(A) Nepal and China are wrong: both are land neighbours to the north, Nepal landlocked and China across the Himalayas, neither reached across the sea

(B) Sri Lanka and the Maldives are wrong, because both share land borders with India

(C) Nepal and Sri Lanka are wrong, because Nepal is maritime and Sri Lanka is a land neighbour

(D) China and the Maldives are wrong, because China is maritime and the Maldives is landlocked

12. India and Pakistan are described as having 'a shared heritage but a divided history', while India and China are separated by the Himalayas. What deeper point about borders do these two descriptions together illustrate?

(A) Borders can divide peoples who share deep cultural roots (India-Pakistan) or follow natural features like mountains (India-China), so political borders and cultural or physical geography do not always coincide

(B) Both pairs show that borders always follow shared culture, so culture decides every boundary

- (C) Both pairs prove that all of India's borders are maritime, drawn across the sea
- (D) Both pairs show India has nothing in common with either neighbour

13. A student equates 'gateway to South-East Asia' (Myanmar) with 'gateway to the sea' (the role of Indian ports for Nepal). Why are these two 'gateway' ideas fundamentally different?

- (A) They are the same: both describe a country reaching the open ocean through a neighbour's coastline
- (B) Myanmar is a land link letting India reach South-East Asian countries overland, while Indian ports are a sea outlet letting landlocked Nepal reach the ocean; one opens a region by land, the other opens the sea for a landlocked country
- (C) They are the same: both describe a sea route that bypasses all land travel
- (D) They differ only in that Myanmar is landlocked while Nepal has a long coast

14. SAARC was formed in 1985, Bangladesh became a separate nation relatively recently, and the Uttarapatha is ancient. Ordering these from oldest to newest, which is correct?

- (A) SAARC in 1985, then the Uttarapatha, then Bangladesh's emergence
- (B) Bangladesh's emergence, then the Uttarapatha, then SAARC in 1985
- (C) The Uttarapatha (ancient), then Bangladesh's emergence as a nation, then SAARC in 1985
- (D) The Uttarapatha, then SAARC in 1985, then Bangladesh's emergence

15. The chapter names three great schools of Buddhism that spread from India. A student matches them to meanings and one match is wrong. Which is the error?

- (A) Calling Theravada 'the teaching of the elders' is wrong
- (B) Calling Vajrayana 'the great vehicle' is wrong; Mahayana means 'the great vehicle', while Vajrayana is the 'diamond vehicle'
- (C) Calling Mahayana 'the great vehicle' is wrong
- (D) Calling Vajrayana 'the diamond vehicle' is wrong

16. Iran and Oman are India's western neighbours linked by sea and old trade, while Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia form a wider maritime neighbourhood to the east. What does grouping all of these as 'neighbours' best demonstrate?

- (A) Neighbourliness reaches across the seas in many directions, so countries far across western and eastern waters can be neighbours through long sea links and trade, not just immediate land borders
- (B) Only countries sharing a land border with India count, so these sea links do not make them neighbours
- (C) All of these are land neighbours sharing borders along the Himalayas
- (D) India's neighbourhood is purely western, since Iran and Oman lie to the west

17. A river rises in the Himalayas shared by several of India's neighbours, flows through India, and reaches the sea in a neighbour's delta. Which two chapter concepts does this

single river best tie together?

- (A) A strait separating two landmasses and an archipelago of low islands
- (B) An open visa-free border and a landlocked country's gateway to the sea
- (C) A shared physical geography (the Himalayas crossing several borders) and a transboundary river that links upstream and downstream neighbours
- (D) The Silk Route overland trade and the three schools of Buddhism

18. A student insists 'a maritime neighbour is a weaker, less important neighbour than a land one because the sea separates rather than joins.' Drawing on the chapter's history, what is the strongest rebuttal?

- (A) True, the sea only separates, so land neighbours always matter more
- (B) The sea has long carried trade, travellers and ideas between coasts, as with India's cultural ties to Sri Lanka and South-East Asia, so a sea link is as genuine and important a bond as a land border
- (C) Maritime neighbours matter only if a bridge is built to join the coasts by land
- (D) Sea links matter only for countries that have no land neighbours at all

19. On a labelled map, four arrows point from India: one north to the Himalayas, one west, one east to a river delta, one south across a narrow strait. Match each arrow to the right neighbour.

- (A) North to Sri Lanka, west to Bangladesh, east to China, south to Pakistan
- (B) North to Bangladesh, west to Sri Lanka, east to Pakistan, south to China
- (C) North to Pakistan, west to China, east to Sri Lanka, south to Bangladesh
- (D) North to China, west to Pakistan, east to Bangladesh, south across the strait to Sri Lanka

20. The Uttarapatha ran north-west toward Central Asia and the Dakshinapatha ran south, while the spice routes crossed the seas. A student claims 'these prove India's regional ties are recent and only economic.' What is wrong with this claim?

- (A) These routes are ancient and carried not only goods but ideas, religion and culture, so India's ties are very old and far more than purely economic
- (B) Nothing is wrong; trade routes show the ties are recent and economic only
- (C) The claim errs only in calling them ancient; they were in fact modern military roads
- (D) The claim errs only in the routes' directions, not in calling the ties recent

21. Nepal and Bhutan are both landlocked, both Himalayan, yet a student says 'because Bhutan sells hydroelectricity and Nepal does not stress this, they have different geographic needs for the sea.' Evaluate.

- (A) Correct: hydroelectricity gives Bhutan its own coastline, so only Nepal needs Indian ports
- (B) Correct: Nepal is actually a coastal country, so only Bhutan is landlocked and needs the sea

- (C) Both in fact reach the sea through Chinese ports, so neither needs India
- (D) Their sea need is the same: both are landlocked and reach the ocean for overseas trade through Indian ports; selling hydroelectricity is about energy, not about whether they need the sea

22. A regional body forms in 1985 so South Asian neighbours can cooperate. A student argues 'such a body must aim to merge the members into one country or let the strongest rule the rest.' What is the correct purpose, and why are both of the student's options wrong?

- (A) The student is right that it merges members, because cooperation means becoming one nation
- (B) The student is right that the strongest rules, because the largest member must lead by force
- (C) SAARC exists to promote cooperation and shared progress among South Asian nations; it neither merges members nor lets one rule the others, since regionalism means working together while staying separate sovereign states
- (D) Its purpose is to end all trade in the region, keeping each country to itself

23. A student lists 'evidence India conquered South-East Asia': Rama-named Thai kings, Angkor Wat's Hindu themes, Borobudur, and the name Suvarnabhumi. What is the single best response?

- (A) All four prove conquest, since such deep cultural marks can only follow military rule
- (B) Only Angkor Wat proves conquest; the rest are coincidences
- (C) None of these is evidence of conquest; each instead reflects Indian culture, religion and names spreading peacefully by trade, travel and teaching, and being adapted locally
- (D) Only the name Suvarnabhumi proves conquest, as naming a land means owning it

24. Comparing the India-Nepal open border with a transboundary river shared by India and Bangladesh, what common lesson about neighbours emerges?

- (A) Both show that borders fully separate neighbours so no cooperation is ever needed
- (B) Both show that one country can act alone without affecting the other
- (C) Both prove the two neighbours are really a single country with one government
- (D) Both an open border and a shared river link two countries so closely that they must cooperate to manage what crosses the boundary, whether people or water

25. Assertion: The Maldives, though tiny and far out at sea, matters greatly to India. Reason: Regional security and friendship depend on every member, so even small island neighbours count. Evaluate.

- (A) The assertion is true but the reason is false, because small countries cannot affect regional security
- (B) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains why the small island neighbour matters

(C) The assertion is false but the reason is true, because the Maldives is too small to matter

(D) Both are false, because only the largest neighbours matter to India

26. A student says 'Sri Lanka is reached by sailing south across a narrow strait, so a strait is just another word for an archipelago.' Correct the confusion.

(A) Correct, both a strait and an archipelago mean a chain of islands

(B) A strait is a narrow channel of sea connecting two larger water bodies and often separating two lands, while an archipelago is a chain or group of many islands; they are different things

(C) Correct, both mean a narrow sea channel between two coasts

(D) A strait is a mountain pass while an archipelago is a desert

27. India shares the Himalayas with several neighbours and shares major rivers fed by them. A student concludes 'therefore each country's water and mountains are entirely its own private property.' Why does the shared geography refute this?

(A) Correct, shared geography means each country fully owns its slice and need not consult others

(B) The conclusion errs only about the mountains, not the rivers, which truly are private

(C) Shared geography means the resources belong to no one, so the question never arises

(D) Because the same mountains and rivers cross several borders, their resources are interlinked across countries, so no single country can treat them as purely private; cooperation is needed

28. Order these neighbours by the PRIMARY historic means India connected with each: Afghanistan, Indonesia, Bangladesh. Which description is correct?

(A) Afghanistan by overland north-west routes, Bangladesh by a shared land border and rivers to the east, Indonesia across the eastern seas

(B) Afghanistan across the seas, Bangladesh by the Himalayas, Indonesia by an open land border

(C) Afghanistan by sea trade, Bangladesh by sailing south, Indonesia by overland mountain routes

(D) All three connected only across the Indian Ocean from the south

29. A student writes: 'China is a maritime neighbour, Nepal has a long coastline, and Myanmar is an island in the Pacific.' How many of these three statements are correct?

(A) Exactly one is correct

(B) Exactly two are correct

(C) None of the three is correct

(D) All three are correct

30. The chapter describes Indian cultural influence reaching Sri Lanka (a near maritime neighbour) and Indonesia (far across the seas). What is the most precise statement of how

these two cases relate?

- (A) Sri Lanka received Indian influence but Indonesia had none at all
- (B) Indonesia received it but Sri Lanka had none
- (C) Sri Lanka received it by conquest and Indonesia by trade, two opposite methods
- (D) Both received strong Indian cultural and religious influence carried by sea, Sri Lanka over short crossings as a near maritime neighbour and Indonesia over longer sea routes, in each case peacefully

31. A 'diaspora' links India with countries across its neighbourhood. A student confuses this with a 'bilateral' agreement. Distinguish the two precisely.

- (A) Both mean an agreement between two countries
- (B) Both mean a community settled far from home
- (C) A diaspora is an agreement among all countries while a bilateral one is within a single country
- (D) A diaspora is a community of people who have spread out and settled far from their original homeland, while a bilateral agreement is an arrangement made between two countries; one is a people, the other is an agreement

32. Two students sail from India: one due south, one due west toward an ancient sea-trading coast. Which neighbours do they first relate to, and how?

- (A) South leads to Afghanistan overland, while west leads to Bhutan in the Himalayas
- (B) South leads to Sri Lanka across a narrow strait as a near maritime neighbour, while west leads toward Iran and Oman, ancient western neighbours linked by sea and old trade
- (C) South leads to China across the Himalayas, while west leads to the Maldives
- (D) South leads to Bangladesh's delta, while west leads to Myanmar, the gateway to South-East Asia

33. A student argues that because the Himalayas separate India and China, 'a natural border means the two can never have any contact or trade.' Why is this an overreach?

- (A) A mountain border shapes and marks the boundary but does not seal it; high passes and history show contact still occurs, so 'natural border' means a geographic divide, not total isolation
- (B) It is correct, because mountains make all contact between neighbours impossible forever
- (C) The error is only that the Himalayas are actually a sea, not mountains
- (D) The error is that India and China share no border at all, only open ocean

34. Rank these as land neighbour, maritime neighbour, or overland-linked western sea-trade neighbour: Bhutan, the Maldives, Oman. Which assignment is correct?

- (A) Bhutan is maritime, the Maldives is a land neighbour, and Oman is landlocked
- (B) Bhutan is a western sea-trade neighbour, the Maldives is landlocked, and Oman is a Himalayan land neighbour

- (C) Bhutan is a landlocked land neighbour, the Maldives is a maritime neighbour, and Oman is an ancient western neighbour linked by sea and old trade
- (D) All three are land neighbours sharing borders with India

35. A planner notes that Nepal's exports leave through an Indian port and Indian culture once reached Indonesia by sea. A student says 'both show India acting only as a route, giving nothing of its own.' Correct this.

- (A) Correct, in both cases India only forwards what others made and contributes nothing
- (B) The error is only about Nepal; with Indonesia India truly conquered and ruled
- (C) In one case India provides a sea gateway for a landlocked neighbour, and in the other India was the source of culture and religion that spread outward, so India both connects neighbours and originates ideas, not merely passes things along
- (D) The error is only about Indonesia; Nepal in fact has its own port and needs no help

36. Assertion: An open border still counts as a real border. Reason: At an open border people cross without a visa, yet the recognised boundary between two sovereign states remains. Evaluate.

- (A) Both are true, but the reason does not explain the assertion
- (B) The assertion is true but the reason is false
- (C) The assertion is false but the reason is true
- (D) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason correctly explains why an open border is still a border

37. India's central position in the Indian Ocean and long coastline are cited as reasons it can have maritime neighbours. A student replies 'but a long coastline only helps fishing, not neighbourliness.' What is the best correction?

- (A) Correct, a coastline only helps fishing and has nothing to do with neighbours
- (B) A long coastline facing a central ocean position places many other coastal lands across the water, so it enables sea links of trade, travel and culture, which is exactly what makes maritime neighbours possible
- (C) A coastline matters only if the country is also landlocked
- (D) A coastline helps only land neighbours, not maritime ones

38. Which single statement correctly links a cause to its effect using chapter facts about Bangladesh?

- (A) Because Bangladesh is landlocked, it depends on Indian ports for all sea access
- (B) Because the Ganga and Brahmaputra flow from India into Bangladesh before reaching the sea, the two countries are upstream-downstream partners who must cooperate over shared water

- (C) Because Bangladesh shares a maritime border far out in the ocean, it has no rivers in common with India
- (D) Because Bangladesh is one of the world's oldest unchanged states, it shares no recent history with India

39. A student claims the Ramakien proves Thailand simply copied India with no creativity. Using the chapter's view, what is the most accurate correction?

- (A) Correct, the Ramakien is an exact, unchanged copy of the Indian Ramayana
- (B) The Ramakien is Thailand's own retelling of the Ramayana, shaped by Thai culture, showing creative adaptation rather than mere copying
- (C) The Ramakien is a Thai trade route, not a story at all
- (D) The Ramakien is one of the three schools of Buddhism

40. India shares a visa-free open border with Nepal but a non-visa-free mountain border with China, and a sea boundary region with Sri Lanka. What general principle about India's boundaries do these three together show?

- (A) India's boundaries take several forms, open land, restricted mountain land, and maritime, so neighbours connect through different kinds of borders, not one uniform type
- (B) All of India's borders are open and visa-free like Nepal's
- (C) All of India's borders are maritime, drawn across the sea
- (D) India has only one border, shared identically with every neighbour

41. A student maps 'wider maritime neighbourhood' onto only the immediate sea neighbours Sri Lanka and the Maldives, excluding Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia. Why is this too narrow?

- (A) The wider maritime neighbourhood extends across the seas to include Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia, not just the nearest island neighbours, because sea links reach farther coasts too
- (B) Correct, only the nearest sea neighbours can belong to the maritime neighbourhood
- (C) Too narrow because Malaysia and Singapore are actually land neighbours across the Himalayas
- (D) Too narrow because Sri Lanka and the Maldives are not maritime neighbours at all

42. Going clockwise from the south, which ordering of India's neighbours by direction is correct?

- (A) Sri Lanka (north), China (south), Myanmar (west), Pakistan (east)
- (B) Bangladesh (south), Sri Lanka (west), Afghanistan (east), China (north-west)
- (C) Myanmar (south), Pakistan (east), Sri Lanka (north), China (west)
- (D) Sri Lanka (south), Pakistan and Afghanistan (west and north-west), China (north), Bangladesh and Myanmar (east)

43. A claim: 'Because India spread Buddhism outward in three schools, India must have borrowed Buddhism from those neighbours first.' What is the logical flaw?

- (A) No flaw; India clearly imported Buddhism from a distant continent
- (B) It reverses the direction: Buddhism was born in India and travelled outward to neighbours in schools like Theravada, Mahayana and Vajrayana, so India was the source, not the borrower
- (C) The flaw is only in the number of schools, which was actually two
- (D) The flaw is that Buddhism never left India at all

44. Pakistan and China both share a land border with India, yet the relationships are described differently, 'shared heritage but divided history' for one and a Himalayan divide for the other. What does this contrast best teach?

- (A) Two countries with land borders always have identical relationships with India
- (B) Both relationships are actually maritime, since the borders run across the sea
- (C) Sharing the same kind of border (land) does not make two relationships the same; one is marked by a shared cultural past, the other by a great mountain barrier
- (D) Neither Pakistan nor China shares any border with India

45. A student says: 'A landlocked country and a maritime country are basically the same because both can trade by sea.' Sharpen the distinction using Nepal and the Maldives.

- (A) They differ sharply: landlocked Nepal has no coast and must borrow a sea route through Indian ports, while the maritime Maldives is itself surrounded by and reached across the sea
- (B) They are the same, since both own coastlines of their own
- (C) Nepal owns a coast while the Maldives is landlocked, so the labels are reversed
- (D) Neither can trade by sea, so the distinction does not matter

46. Which chain of reasoning correctly explains why India's neighbours form a 'neighbourhood' bound by more than borders?

- (A) Only modern aeroplane travel connects the neighbours, so the ties are recent
- (B) A single shared government rules all the neighbours, binding them together
- (C) Shared mountains and rivers, ancient trade routes, and the spread of religion and culture have linked these countries for centuries, so the neighbourhood is held together by deep geographic, historical and cultural ties as well as borders
- (D) One common currency used by every neighbour is what binds the neighbourhood

47. Assertion: Indian culture is found across Thailand, Cambodia and Indonesia. Reason: India conquered these lands and imposed its culture by force. Evaluate.

- (A) The assertion is true but the reason is false; the culture spread peacefully through trade, travel and religion, not by conquest
- (B) Both the assertion and the reason are true, and the reason explains the assertion

- (C) The assertion is false but the reason is true
- (D) Both the assertion and the reason are false

48. A river fed by Himalayan snow is shared at its source by several neighbours and crosses into India and then a neighbour's delta. A student calls it 'a strait because it connects two lands.' Why is the term wrong, and what is correct?

- (A) Correct, any feature connecting two lands is a strait
- (B) It is a transboundary river, not a strait; a strait is a narrow channel of sea, while this is a river of fresh water crossing several countries' borders
- (C) It is an archipelago, since it touches many islands
- (D) It is a landlocked lake, since it never reaches the sea

49. India's ties with Iran and Oman are 'ancient' and by sea, while SAARC is from 1985. A student says 'so India's western ties are newer than its South Asian cooperation.' Why is this wrong?

- (A) India's sea-trade ties with Iran and Oman are ancient, far older than SAARC (1985), so the western ties are the older, not the newer, of the two
- (B) Correct, the western sea ties began only after SAARC formed in 1985
- (C) Wrong only because Iran and Oman are eastern, not western, neighbours
- (D) Wrong only because SAARC was formed in ancient times, before the Iran-Oman trade

50. Which single set correctly pairs a place with the kind of evidence it provides for India's peaceful cultural spread?

- (A) Borobudur in Indonesia (a Buddhist monument), Angkor Wat in Cambodia (a Hindu-themed temple), and the Ramakien in Thailand (a local retelling of the Ramayana)
- (B) Borobudur in Bhutan, Angkor Wat in Sri Lanka, and the Ramakien in Afghanistan
- (C) Borobudur as a trade route, Angkor Wat as a school of Buddhism, and the Ramakien as a strait
- (D) Borobudur in Indonesia, Angkor Wat in Afghanistan, and the Ramakien as an Indian epic unchanged

51. A student reasons: 'Since neighbours share rivers, mountains and history, the best policy is for each to act alone to protect its own interests.' Why does the chapter's logic point the other way?

- (A) Correct, acting alone is best because shared features belong to no one
- (B) The chapter says each country should seal its borders and ignore the others
- (C) The chapter recommends merging all neighbours into one country to end disputes
- (D) Because the shared rivers, mountains and history tie the countries' fortunes together, acting alone often harms shared resources; cooperation and regionalism better protect everyone's interests

52. On a quiz, four 'pairs' are offered for the term and its meaning. Which pair is the only fully correct one?

- (A) Archipelago, meaning an extensive group or chain of islands
- (B) Strait, meaning a chain of many islands
- (C) Diaspora, meaning a narrow channel of sea
- (D) Bilateral, meaning an agreement among all the countries of the world

53. A neighbour lies east of India, shares a long land border and many transboundary rivers, became a separate nation relatively recently, and sits on a low delta by the sea. Name it and reject a likely confusion.

- (A) Bangladesh; it should not be confused with the Maldives, which lies south across the sea as an archipelago and is not a land or river neighbour
- (B) Nepal; not to be confused with Bhutan, both being landlocked Himalayan kingdoms
- (C) Sri Lanka; not to be confused with the Maldives, both being southern islands
- (D) Myanmar; not to be confused with Afghanistan, both being north-western neighbours

54. Which statement best integrates geography and history to explain why India can be called central to its region?

- (A) India is central only because it is landlocked and ringed by mountains on every side
- (B) India's long coastline and central Indian Ocean position let it reach maritime neighbours by sea, while its land borders and ancient overland routes linked it to land neighbours, so both geography and history place India at the region's heart
- (C) India is central only because it shares one common currency with all neighbours
- (D) India is central only in modern times, having had no ancient links to its neighbours

55. A student says: 'Bhutan is the Land of the Thunder Dragon and uses Gross National Happiness, so it must reject trade and money entirely.' Correct this with the chapter's facts.

- (A) Correct, GNH means Bhutan refuses all trade and money
- (B) Bhutan rejects money but is not the Land of the Thunder Dragon
- (C) Bhutan still trades, notably selling hydroelectricity, and GNH weighs wellbeing, environment, governance and culture alongside, not instead of, economic life, so it does not reject money entirely
- (D) Bhutan accepts money but does not use Gross National Happiness

56. Why does the chapter treat 'regionalism' as the opposite of countries acting purely alone or fighting?

- (A) Regionalism means the strongest country conquering the rest to unify the region
- (B) Regionalism means each country ignoring its neighbours entirely

(C) Regionalism means all neighbours merging into a single nation with one government

(D) Regionalism means neighbouring countries working together for peace, stability and shared progress, which contrasts with both isolation and conflict

57. A student claims the open border, the transboundary rivers, and SAARC all point to the same underlying idea about India and its neighbours. What is that shared idea?

(A) That neighbours are best kept entirely separate and self-sufficient

(B) That neighbours are deeply interconnected and benefit most by cooperating, whether on crossings, shared waters, or regional progress

(C) That India should rule its neighbours to settle every dispute

(D) That the connections between neighbours are all very recent inventions

58. A capstone claim states: 'Sri Lanka is no neighbour without a land border, Nepal's open border makes it part of India, landlocked Bhutan has no use for the sea, and India conquered Indonesia to spread its culture.' How many of these four are correct?

(A) Exactly one is correct

(B) Exactly two are correct

(C) None of the four is correct

(D) Exactly three are correct

59. A merchant in the ancient Ganga plains wants to sell goods both to Central Asia and to the southern peninsula. Which pair of routes would he most likely use, and what does using both reveal?

(A) The Silk Route south to Sri Lanka and the spice route north to Afghanistan, showing only sea trade existed

(B) The Uttarapatha to the south and the Dakshinapatha to the north, showing the routes ran opposite to their names

(C) A single maritime route in both directions, showing India had no overland trade at all

(D) The Uttarapatha toward the north-west and Central Asia and the Dakshinapatha toward the south; using both shows India was linked outward in several directions by overland trade long ago

60. A student argues that since Indian culture spread peacefully to South-East Asia, 'this must have happened quickly and only once, like a single event.' Why does the chapter's evidence suggest otherwise?

(A) Correct, the spread was a single rapid event carried by one voyage

(B) The many and varied traces, monuments, royal names, retold epics and an old regional name like Suvarnabhumi, point to a long, repeated exchange over centuries through ongoing trade and travel, not a single event

(C) The evidence shows the spread happened only in modern times in one decade

(D) The evidence shows India sent one army once, which settled the matter quickly

Solutions — Social Science (Class 7), Chapter 14: India and Her Neighbours — Paper 5

Paper 5 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	D	11	A	21	D	31	D	41	A	51	D
2	A	12	A	22	C	32	B	42	D	52	A
3	D	13	B	23	C	33	A	43	B	53	A
4	B	14	C	24	D	34	C	44	C	54	B
5	C	15	B	25	B	35	C	45	A	55	C
6	D	16	A	26	B	36	D	46	C	56	D
7	D	17	C	27	D	37	B	47	A	57	B
8	C	18	B	28	A	38	B	48	B	58	C
9	C	19	D	29	C	39	B	49	A	59	D
10	C	20	A	30	D	40	A	50	A	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (D) The deciding test is whether a country touches India by a land boundary; if it does not but lies across the sea, it is a maritime neighbour. Sri Lanka is a large island that does have land, so the student's 'pure ocean' rule would refuse to file it under maritime, yet it shares no land border, so it cannot be a land neighbour either, leaving it absurdly uncategorised. The fix is to define maritime by the absence of a shared land border plus a sea link, which places Sri Lanka correctly. The option calling the rule a perfect match ignores that Sri Lanka is land, not pure ocean. Filing it under land neighbours is false because no land boundary is shared. Deleting it as a non-neighbour wrongly assumes only land borders make neighbours, the central misconception of the chapter.

2. (A) A boundary's length and the count of neighbours along it are independent: a long coast might face only a couple of maritime neighbours while a shorter land boundary could be split among several countries, so the comparison of kilometres tells us nothing about how many neighbours of each kind exist. The 'sound' option assumes length translates directly into neighbour count, which is the error. Claiming the coastline is longer

contradicts the given figures (15,100 km land exceeds 11,100 km coast). Saying India has no maritime neighbours is plainly false, since Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours.

3. (D) Nepal sits in the lap of the Himalayas with no coastline, so its overseas trade travels out through Indian ports, while the Maldives is a nation of islets, all coast yet tiny and dispersed, leaning on regional cooperation. The contrast is land-locked versus island. Calling Bhutan a maritime archipelago is false; Bhutan is landlocked. Saying Sri Lanka is landlocked and the Maldives sits in the Himalayas reverses every fact, both are southern sea neighbours. Calling Pakistan landlocked and Afghanistan an island chain is doubly wrong: Pakistan has a coast and Afghanistan is a landlocked overland neighbour.

4. (B) The Uttarapatha was the ancient northern overland route linking the Ganga plains toward Central Asia through the north-west, passing through Afghanistan, and the Buddhist remains along it prove sustained contact, refuting any claim of isolation. The Dakshinapatha was the southern route, not a path to Afghanistan, and a southern sea route cannot describe a north-west mountain crossing. Myanmar lies east and is a land gateway to South-East Asia, not a north-west overland link. Bhutan is a Himalayan neighbour, not the route to Central Asia, and the description does not match it.

5. (C) A transboundary river crosses one or more borders, so upstream actions change downstream flow; this links India and Bangladesh and makes joint management by agreement the sound principle. Claiming India may take all the water assumes a shared river belongs to the upstream country alone, which the transboundary idea denies. A wall cannot stop a river and would only cause harm, not cooperation. Saying the rivers stop at the border ignores that water keeps flowing across it, the very point of 'transboundary'.

6. (D) Gross National Happiness adds wellbeing, environmental care, good governance and culture to, not instead of, economic life, and hydroelectricity from fast-flowing Himalayan rivers is a clean income source that fits an environment-minded outlook, so the two facts sit together. Saying GNH forbids all earning misreads it; it values money alongside other goods. Saying electricity sales prove a money-only focus ignores that GNH weighs wellbeing too. Saying GNH measures only the army is false; the army is not what GNH tracks at all.

7. (D) An open border is visa-free yet remains a real boundary between two sovereign states, and the very freedom of movement is what makes cooperation on safety and order necessary, so Vir's reasoning holds. Aria's first claim treats 'open' as 'absent', which the chapter rejects. Her merger claim is false, Nepal keeps its own government. The last option reaches Vir's conclusion through a false premise: India and Nepal share a land border, not a maritime one.

8. (C) Cultural influence can travel without armies, and the Thai names and the Ramakien reflect ideas carried by traders, travellers and teachers, with the Ramakien being a

distinctly Thai retelling rather than a copy. The 'right' option wrongly equates resemblance with conquest. Calling the echoes coincidence denies the genuine cultural link the chapter affirms. Claiming Thailand conquered India reverses the direction of a peaceful, India-originating spread.

9. (C) Hindu-themed Angkor Wat, Buddhist Borobudur and the name Suvarnabhumi together point to ideas, faiths and art carried by sea trade and travel and reshaped by local cultures, a peaceful exchange. The colonial-rule option contradicts the chapter's insistence that the spread was not by conquest. Claiming no contact until modern times ignores ancient evidence like Suvarnabhumi. Calling them coincidences denies the consistent Indian cultural origin the three examples share.

10. (C) The Maldives and Sri Lanka are maritime neighbours to the south, China is the Himalayan neighbour to the north, and Pakistan lies to the west and north-west, so the southward-to-north-west ordering is correct. Placing Pakistan and China to the south contradicts their northern/north-western positions. Putting Sri Lanka and the Maldives to the north across the Himalayas is impossible, as they are southern sea neighbours. The third wrong option scrambles every direction.

11. (A) Maritime neighbours are reached across the sea without a shared land border; Sri Lanka and the Maldives qualify, but Nepal is a landlocked land neighbour and China is a Himalayan land neighbour, so those two are misplaced. Calling Sri Lanka and the Maldives wrong falsely claims they share land borders. The third option inverts the truth, Nepal is not maritime and Sri Lanka is not a land neighbour. The fourth wrongly labels China maritime and the Maldives landlocked, both reversed.

12. (A) The India-Pakistan phrase shows a border slicing through a shared heritage, while the India-China case shows a border tracing a mountain range, together revealing that political lines may cut across culture or follow physical geography, the two need not align. The claim that borders always follow shared culture is contradicted by the Himalayan, geography-drawn India-China border. Calling both borders maritime is false, both are land borders. Saying India shares nothing with either ignores the explicit 'shared heritage' with Pakistan.

13. (B) Myanmar being a gateway to South-East Asia means it links India by land toward that region's countries, whereas Indian ports serve as Nepal's gateway to the sea, giving a landlocked country ocean access; the first is overland regional access, the second is sea access. Calling them the same as ocean-via-coastline ignores that Myanmar's role is overland regional linkage. Calling both sea routes bypassing land is false for Myanmar. The last option reverses the facts, Myanmar is not landlocked and Nepal has no coast.

14. (C) The Uttarapatha is an ancient trade route, Bangladesh became a separate nation relatively recently (the 'newborn neighbour'), and SAARC was founded in 1985, so oldest to newest runs Uttarapatha, then Bangladesh, then SAARC. Placing SAARC first puts a

1985 body before an ancient route, which is impossible. Placing the Uttarapatha after Bangladesh denies its antiquity. Placing Bangladesh after 1985 SAARC is wrong because Bangladesh predates SAARC's founding.

15. (B) Theravada means 'the teaching of the elders', Mahayana 'the great vehicle', and Vajrayana the 'diamond vehicle'; so labelling Vajrayana 'the great vehicle' confuses it with Mahayana and is the error. The other three statements correctly state each meaning, so they are not the mistake.

16. (A) Including Iran and Oman in the west and Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia in the east shows that sea links and trade make distant coastal lands neighbours in many directions, beyond immediate land borders. The land-border-only option contradicts the whole idea of maritime neighbours. Calling them Himalayan land neighbours is geographically false. Saying the neighbourhood is purely western ignores the eastern maritime group named alongside Iran and Oman.

17. (C) The river's Himalayan source shared by several neighbours shows a common physical geography crossing borders, and its flow into a neighbour's delta makes it transboundary, tying upstream and downstream together, so both concepts apply. A strait and an archipelago describe sea features, not a Himalayan river. An open border and a landlocked gateway concern crossings and ports, not the river's shared source. The Silk Route and Buddhist schools are trade and religion, unrelated to this river's geography.

18. (B) Sea routes carried goods, people and culture, building deep ties such as those with Sri Lanka and South-East Asia, so a maritime bond is fully genuine and important, rebutting the 'weaker' claim. Agreeing that the sea only separates ignores this connecting history. The bridge condition is false, sea links work without bridges. The 'only if no land neighbours' option wrongly makes maritime ties conditional, when India has both kinds at once.

19. (D) China lies north across the Himalayas, Pakistan to the west, Bangladesh to the east with its river delta, and Sri Lanka to the south across the narrow strait, so that mapping is correct. The other three options scramble these directions, for instance placing Sri Lanka to the north or Bangladesh to the west, which contradict the chapter's geography.

20. (A) The Uttarapatha, Dakshinapatha and spice routes are ancient and carried ideas, faith and culture as well as goods, so the ties are old and far broader than economics, refuting both halves of the claim. Calling the ties recent and economic-only repeats the error. Calling the routes modern military roads is false, they were ancient trade routes. Conceding only a direction error leaves the false 'recent' claim standing, which the chapter contradicts.

21. (D) Hydroelectricity is an energy resource and has nothing to do with sea access; both Nepal and Bhutan are landlocked and depend on Indian ports for overseas trade, so their need for the sea is the same. Saying hydroelectricity gives Bhutan a coastline is nonsense, electricity does not create coast. Calling Nepal coastal is false, it is landlocked. The Chinese-ports claim contradicts the chapter, which names Indian ports as their gateway to the sea.

22. (C) SAARC promotes cooperation and shared progress among South Asian countries that remain separate sovereign states, so neither merger nor rule by force fits, that is what regionalism means. The merger option misreads cooperation as union. The rule-by-force option contradicts the equal-cooperation idea. Ending all trade is the opposite of a cooperative body's aim.

23. (C) Each item is a trace of peaceful cultural spread, traders, travellers and teachers carrying ideas and faith that locals adapted, not of conquest, so none supports the student's claim. The 'all prove conquest' option repeats the central misconception. Singling out Angkor Wat as conquest while calling the rest coincidence still misreads peaceful adaptation. Claiming a name proves ownership is false, Suvarnabhumi was a name born of trade knowledge, not rule.

24. (D) An open border lets people cross and a transboundary river lets water cross, and in each case what crosses the boundary ties the two countries together and demands cooperation, the shared lesson. Saying borders fully separate ignores that both cases involve things crossing. Saying one country can act alone contradicts the interdependence of crossing flows. Claiming they form one country misreads cooperation between sovereign states as merger.

25. (B) The Maldives does matter to India, and the stated reason, that regional security and friendship rest on every member including small islands, is exactly why, so both are true and the reason explains the assertion. Calling the reason false denies that small members affect security. Calling the assertion false repeats the size-based misconception the chapter rejects. Calling both false ignores that even small neighbours count.

26. (B) A strait is a narrow sea channel linking larger waters and often separating two lands (as between India and Sri Lanka), whereas an archipelago is a group or chain of many islands (like the Maldives), so the two terms differ. Equating both with a chain of islands ignores the strait's meaning. Equating both with a sea channel ignores the archipelago's meaning. Calling a strait a mountain pass and an archipelago a desert is wrong on both counts.

27. (D) Mountains and rivers that span borders link the countries' resources, so they cannot be treated as wholly private and must be managed cooperatively, which refutes the conclusion. Agreeing each country fully owns its slice ignores the cross-border linkage. Conceding only the mountains leaves the false private-rivers claim, yet rivers are

transboundary too. Saying they belong to no one wrongly removes any need to manage them, when shared use is exactly why cooperation matters.

28. (A) Afghanistan was linked by the north-west overland route (the Uttarapatha), Bangladesh shares a land border and transboundary rivers to the east, and Indonesia lies across the eastern seas, so that mapping is right. Calling Afghanistan a sea connection is false, it was overland. Saying Indonesia connected by overland mountain routes ignores that it lies across the sea. Saying all three connect only from the south misplaces all three.

29. (C) China is a land neighbour across the Himalayas, not maritime; Nepal is landlocked with no coastline; and Myanmar is a land neighbour to the east, the gateway to South-East Asia, not a Pacific island. All three statements are false, so none is correct. Any option claiming one, two, or three correct overcounts these errors.

30. (D) Both Sri Lanka and Indonesia absorbed Indian culture and religion brought peacefully by sea, the difference being only the distance of the crossing, near versus far. Saying Indonesia had none ignores Borobudur and Suvarnabhumi. Saying Sri Lanka had none ignores its long shared religious history. Claiming Sri Lanka's influence came by conquest contradicts the chapter's peaceful-spread theme.

31. (D) A diaspora is people settled away from their homeland; a bilateral agreement is a deal between two countries, so one is a population and the other a pact. Equating both with a two-country agreement erases the diaspora's human meaning. Equating both with a settled community erases the bilateral's meaning. The last option misdefines both, a bilateral deal is between two countries, not within one.

32. (B) Sailing south from India's tip reaches Sri Lanka across the strait, and sailing west reaches the western sea-trade neighbours Iran and Oman, so that pairing is correct. Afghanistan is reached overland to the north-west, not by sailing south. China is northern and reached over the Himalayas, not south by sea. Bangladesh and Myanmar lie to the east, not south or west.

33. (A) The Himalayas mark the India-China boundary but a natural barrier shapes contact rather than ending it entirely, so claiming no contact ever is an overreach. Agreeing that mountains make contact impossible forever repeats the error. Calling the Himalayas a sea is factually wrong. Saying the two share no border denies the well-known Himalayan land border.

34. (C) Bhutan is a landlocked Himalayan land neighbour, the Maldives is a maritime island neighbour, and Oman is a western neighbour linked by sea and old trade, so the assignment is correct. Calling Bhutan maritime and the Maldives a land neighbour reverses both. Calling the Maldives landlocked and Oman Himalayan is doubly false. Calling all three land neighbours ignores that the Maldives and Oman are reached by sea.

35. (C) The two cases differ: India offers a sea gateway to landlocked Nepal and was itself the origin of culture that travelled to Indonesia, so India both links neighbours and gives ideas of its own. The 'only forwards' option ignores India as a cultural source. The conquest claim about Indonesia contradicts the peaceful-spread theme. Saying Nepal has its own port is false, Nepal is landlocked and uses Indian ports.

36. (D) An open border is indeed a real border, and the reason, that the recognised boundary stays even while crossing is visa-free, is exactly why, so both are true and the reason explains the assertion. Saying the reason fails to explain ignores that the persisting boundary is the very point. Calling the reason false denies the visa-free-yet-recognised fact. Calling the assertion false repeats the 'open means no border' misconception.

37. (B) A long coastline at the centre of an ocean means many coastal lands lie across the water and can be reached by sea, enabling the trade and cultural links that create maritime neighbours, so it does far more than help fishing. Limiting it to fishing ignores this connecting role. A country cannot be both coastal and landlocked, so that option is incoherent. A coastline serves sea links and thus maritime neighbours, not land ones, making the last option backwards.

38. (B) The Ganga and Brahmaputra crossing from India into Bangladesh make them upstream-downstream partners needing water cooperation, a valid cause and effect. Bangladesh is not landlocked; it is a delta with its own coast, so the port-dependence claim is false. It shares land and rivers with India, not a distant maritime-only border. It is a 'newborn neighbour', recently formed, not an ancient unchanged state.

39. (B) The Ramakien is Thailand's distinct retelling of the Ramayana, reshaped by Thai culture, which is creative adaptation, not copying. Calling it an exact copy is wrong because it was adapted locally. Calling it a trade route confuses an epic with a route. Calling it a school of Buddhism confuses a story with Theravada, Mahayana or Vajrayana.

40. (A) The Nepal (open land), China (restricted mountain land) and Sri Lanka (maritime) cases show India's borders come in several forms, illustrating varied connection types. Saying all are open like Nepal's ignores the restricted China border. Saying all are maritime ignores the two land borders. Saying India has one identical border denies the clear differences among these three.

41. (A) The wider maritime neighbourhood reaches across the seas to Malaysia, Singapore and Indonesia as well as the nearby islands, so excluding them is too narrow. Limiting it to the nearest neighbours repeats the error. Calling Malaysia and Singapore Himalayan land neighbours is false, they lie across the seas to the east. Denying that Sri Lanka and the Maldives are maritime neighbours contradicts the chapter.

42. (D) From the south clockwise: Sri Lanka lies south, Pakistan and Afghanistan west and north-west, China north, and Bangladesh and Myanmar east, which is correct. The

other options misplace directions, for example putting Sri Lanka north or China south or Bangladesh south, all contradicting the chapter's map.

43. (B) Buddhism originated in India and spread outward to neighbours in its three schools, so the claim reverses the flow by calling India a borrower. Saying India imported it repeats the reversal. Quibbling over the number ignores that there were three schools and leaves the direction error. Saying Buddhism never left India contradicts the very spread the question describes.

44. (C) Pakistan and China both have land borders, yet one relationship rests on a shared heritage and the other on a mountain divide, showing the same border type can carry very different relationships. Saying land borders mean identical relationships ignores this contrast. Calling the borders maritime is false, both are land borders. Denying any border contradicts the premise that both share land borders.

45. (A) Nepal is landlocked, borrowing sea access via Indian ports, whereas the Maldives is itself a sea-surrounded archipelago, a sharp difference in access. Saying both own coastlines is false for landlocked Nepal. Reversing the labels misstates both. Saying neither can trade by sea ignores that the Maldives is maritime and Nepal trades via Indian ports.

46. (C) Shared physical geography, ancient routes and the peaceful spread of religion and culture have bound these countries over centuries, so the neighbourhood rests on geographic, historical and cultural ties beyond mere borders. The aeroplane option wrongly makes the ties recent. There is no single government over all neighbours. There is no common currency across them; these last two invent bonds the chapter never claims.

47. (A) Indian culture truly is found across those lands, but the reason is false because the spread was peaceful through trade, travel and teaching, not conquest, so the assertion is true and the reason false. Saying both are true endorses the false conquest reason. Saying the assertion is false denies the well-attested cultural presence. Saying both are false wrongly rejects the genuine cultural spread.

48. (B) A feature of flowing fresh water crossing borders is a transboundary river; a strait is a narrow sea channel, so the term is misapplied. Calling anything connecting two lands a strait ignores that a strait is specifically sea. An archipelago is a group of islands, not a river. A landlocked lake has no sea outlet, but this river does reach the sea through the delta.

49. (A) The Iran-Oman sea trade is described as ancient, predating the 1985 founding of SAARC, so the western ties are older, making the student's ordering backwards. Saying the western ties began after 1985 repeats the error. Iran and Oman are western neighbours, so that 'eastern' correction is itself wrong. SAARC dates to 1985, not ancient times, so the last option misstates a clear fact.

50. (A) Borobudur stands in Indonesia, Angkor Wat in Cambodia, and the Ramakien is Thailand's retelling of the Ramayana, each evidence of peaceful cultural spread, so this set is correct. Placing Borobudur in Bhutan and Angkor Wat in Sri Lanka misplaces both. Calling them a trade route, a school of Buddhism and a strait misidentifies all three. Putting Angkor Wat in Afghanistan and calling the Ramakien an unchanged Indian epic is wrong on both counts.

51. (D) Shared rivers, mountains and history make the countries interdependent, so acting alone can damage common resources, and cooperation through regionalism serves everyone, the opposite of the student's policy. Saying acting alone is best ignores this interdependence. Sealing borders contradicts the cooperative ties the chapter stresses. Merging into one country misreads regionalism, which keeps members separate while cooperating.

52. (A) An archipelago is an extensive group or chain of islands, so that pair is correct. A strait is a narrow sea channel, not a chain of islands. A diaspora is a community settled far from its homeland, not a sea channel. A bilateral agreement is between two countries, not among all of them.

53. (A) The clues, eastern land border, transboundary rivers, recent nationhood and a low coastal delta, point to Bangladesh, and the likely confusion is the southern island Maldives, which is maritime, not a land or river neighbour. Nepal is landlocked with no delta or coast, so it does not fit. Sri Lanka is a southern island without a shared land border. Myanmar lies east but is the gateway to South-East Asia, not described as a recently formed delta nation.

54. (B) India's coastline and ocean position open sea links to maritime neighbours while its land borders and old routes connected it to land neighbours, so geography and history together make it central. Calling India landlocked is false, it has a long coast. There is no common currency across the neighbours. The 'only modern' claim ignores the ancient routes and cultural ties the chapter describes.

55. (C) Bhutan, the Land of the Thunder Dragon, earns from hydroelectricity and uses GNH to weigh wellbeing and environment alongside income, so it does not reject money. Saying GNH refuses all trade misreads it. Denying the Thunder Dragon name contradicts the chapter. Denying that Bhutan uses GNH also contradicts the chapter; both names and the GNH approach are correct.

56. (D) Regionalism is neighbours cooperating for peace, stability and shared progress, so it stands against both fighting and going it alone. Conquest by the strongest is the opposite of cooperation. Ignoring neighbours is isolation, not regionalism. Merging into one nation is union, not cooperation among separate states.

57. (B) An open border, shared rivers and SAARC all show interconnection and the value of cooperation, the shared idea. Keeping neighbours separate contradicts these cooperative links. Ruling neighbours contradicts cooperation among sovereign states. Calling the connections recent ignores the ancient roots of many ties, though even SAARC's cooperation reflects long-standing interdependence.

58. (C) Sri Lanka is a maritime neighbour despite no land border; Nepal's open border is a real boundary, not a merger; landlocked Bhutan still needs the sea via Indian ports; and Indian culture reached Indonesia peacefully, not by conquest. All four claims are false, so none is correct. Any option counting one or more correct accepts at least one of these classic misconceptions.

59. (D) The Uttarapatha was the northern overland route toward Central Asia and the Dakshinapatha the southern route, so a merchant trading both ways would use both, revealing India's ancient multi-directional overland trade. The first wrong option swaps the routes' meanings and wrongly limits trade to the sea. The second reverses the north-south orientation of the two named routes. The third denies overland trade entirely, contradicting the existence of these very routes.

60. (B) Diverse, deep traces such as monuments, Rama-named kings, the Ramakien and the name Suvarnabhumi reflect repeated contact built up over centuries of trade and travel, not a one-off event. Calling it a single voyage ignores this accumulated breadth. Placing it in one modern decade contradicts its ancient roots. Invoking a single army contradicts the peaceful, gradual, non-military spread the chapter stresses.